

# Database of third sector organisations: schema and process

Fiona Couper Kenney, Alan Duggan

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## 1 Introduction

This document is a guide to the UK Third Sector and Civil Society Database, a ‘spine’ of all registered organisations comprising the third sector and civil society in the United Kingdom, along with linkages between organisations which appear in more than one register. The dataset is available at the project website<sup>1</sup>.

Ten data sources are combined in order to build the organisational spine, listed in Table 1, and further detailed in appendices. This document briefly introduces the processes of data collection, pre-processing of data per source, and combining all sources to create one master list. The spine files are first introduced, followed by a description of the process of matching organisations between sources. Preprocessing of each source is detailed in the appendix. The project source code is available on GitHub<sup>2</sup>.

## 2 Building the organisational spine

Ten data sources are combined to create the organisational spine. All data in the spine is open and publicly available. The sources and their online location are listed in Table 1.

| Data Source                           | URL                                                                                                                                                                      |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Charity Commission, England and Wales | <a href="http://www.gov.uk/government/organisations/charity-commission">www.gov.uk/government/organisations/charity-commission</a>                                       |
| Scottish Charity Register             | <a href="http://www.oscr.org.uk/">www.oscr.org.uk/</a>                                                                                                                   |
| Charity Commission, Northern Ireland  | <a href="http://www.charitycommissionni.org.uk/">www.charitycommissionni.org.uk/</a>                                                                                     |
| Mutuals Public Register               | <a href="http://mutuals.fca.org.uk">mutuals.fca.org.uk</a>                                                                                                               |
| Companies House                       | <a href="http://www.gov.uk/government/organisations/companies-house">www.gov.uk/government/organisations/companies-house</a>                                             |
| Co-operatives                         | <a href="http://www.uk.coop/">www.uk.coop/</a>                                                                                                                           |
| Scottish Housing Register             | <a href="http://www.housingregulator.gov.scot/">www.housingregulator.gov.scot/</a>                                                                                       |
| Social Housing England                | <a href="http://www.gov.uk/government/publications/registered-providers-of-social-housing">www.gov.uk/government/publications/registered-providers-of-social-housing</a> |
| Care Inspectorate Scotland            | <a href="http://www.careinspectorate.com">www.careinspectorate.com</a>                                                                                                   |
| Care Quality Commission               | <a href="http://www.cqc.org.uk">www.cqc.org.uk</a>                                                                                                                       |

Table 1: Data sources for the organisational spine

The organisational spine consists of three csv files:

- TSCS\_spine.spine.csv contains a row for each organisation considered to make up the UK’s third sector, with name, address and date details. The data dictionary is found in Table 2.
- TSCS\_spine.supplementary.csv contains any name, address and date information associated with an organisation which is additional to what is in the spine, such as ‘Also Known As’ names, previous addresses. See Table 3 for data dictionary

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<sup>1</sup><https://uk-third-sector-database.github.io/>

<sup>2</sup><https://github.com/uk-third-sector-database/tso-database-builder>

- TSCS\_spine.matches.csv lists the organisations which are linked or matched according to our searches (see 2.1), along with the type of match. Data dictionary in Table 4

| Fieldname        | Notes                                                                                    |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| uid              | UID created for each source, e.g. GB-CHC-1234                                            |
| organisationname | Name as primary in source                                                                |
| normalisedname   | Name normalised to capitalise, remove extra spaces and punctuation - to aid matching     |
| fulladdress      | Full address as found in source with highest precedence across any matched organisations |
| city             | City matching full address as defined above                                              |
| postcode         | Postcode matching full address as defined above                                          |
| registerdate     | Earliest registration date found in records for this organisation across all sources     |
| removeddate      | Latest dissolution date found in records for this organisation across all sources        |
| source_register  | Source of the data, e.g. Charity Commission for England and Wales                        |
| is_cic           | Boolean indicating if organisation is a Community Interest Company                       |

Table 2: Public spine csv fields

| Fieldname        | Notes                                                                                  |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| uid              | UID created for each source using source and id from original source                   |
| organisationname | Alternative name                                                                       |
| normalisedname   | (Alt name normalised)                                                                  |
| fulladdress      | Alternative address                                                                    |
| city             | Alternative address                                                                    |
| postcode         | Alternative address                                                                    |
| registerdate     | Alternative registration date                                                          |
| removeddate      | Alternative removed / dissolved date                                                   |
| source_register  | Source of the data, e.g. 'Companies House', 'Charity Commission for England and Wales' |

Table 3: Supplementary csv fields

| Fieldname         | Notes                                                                                   |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| uid               | UID created for each source, matches Table 2 - if match is unambiguous; blank otherwise |
| orgA_id_in_source | ID in original source, for matched organisation A                                       |
| orgA_source       | original source of organisation A                                                       |
| orgA_uid          | UID created for organisation A                                                          |
| orgB_id_in_source | ID in original source, for matched organisation B                                       |
| orgB_source       | original source of organisation B                                                       |
| orgB_uid          | UID created for organisation B                                                          |
| match_type        | Type of match (e.g. by name, by companyid)                                              |

Table 4: Matched organisations fields

## 2.1 What constitutes a match?

The main dataset has one row per organisation. If an organisation appears in two datasets, the linked organisation is noted by a row in the matches lookup table. We prioritise those organisations on the charity register, and add new organisations to the main dataset from other sources only if they do not match one already present in the set.

The following routes lead to a match:

- Matching by Company ID:

The charity regulator in England and Wales, CCEW, collects information about organisations' associated registration at Companies House. If two charities share the same companyid they match the same companies house record and are therefore linked.

This same companyid is used to generate matches between CCEW and Companies House directly.

Our historic data from Scotland's charity regulator, OSCR, contains a company identifier for some organisations. This is used for a deterministic match between OSCR and Companies House.

Organisations in the Cooperatives register may have an additional id, 'Registered Number', which represents its linkage to the Mutuels Public Register. Matches are thus sought between CoOps and Mutuels using this id.

- Matching by Normalised Name:

If two organisations have the same normalised name they are tentatively matched, but require an additional check. Any of the following being true will create a match:

1. Organisation is in Care Quality Commission (CQC) data, and the matched core organisation is flagged as having a CQC registration, which is a flag in CCEW data.
2. Organisation is in the Scottish charity regular (OSCR) register and has a 'cross border' flag, indicating that a match is expected between itself and an organisation in CCEW.
3. Organisation is in Scottish Housing Regulator or Care Inspectorate Scotland, and normalised name match is with an organisation in OSCR.
4. Organisation is in Social Housing England Regulator or Care Quality Commission, and matches an organisation in CCEW.

- Matching using work by Find That Charity:

A lookup table provided by David Kane<sup>3</sup> is also used to generate matches. These links include historic re-registrations, allowing this dataset to be further deduplicated.

The order in Table 5 shows the precedence given to sources where matches occur: the higher precedence source will provide the data and unique identifier (uid) in the main spine table. Matches will be found in the matches table, and any data found in addition to the primary fields will be in the supplementary table, indexed by the uid given at source. The first eight sources are processed such that any organisations not already present in the dataset are added to it. Organisations registered with CIS and CQC are only noted in the matches table where they link to a source present.

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<sup>3</sup>[https://raw.githubusercontent.com/drkane/charity-lookups/master/relationships/\\_sameas.csv](https://raw.githubusercontent.com/drkane/charity-lookups/master/relationships/_sameas.csv)

| Order | Source                                | Code |
|-------|---------------------------------------|------|
| 1     | Charity Commission, England and Wales | CHC  |
| 2     | Scottish Charity Register             | SC   |
| 3     | Charity Commission, Northern Ireland  | NIC  |
| 4     | Mutuals Public Register               | MPR  |
| 5     | Companies House                       | COH  |
| 6     | Co-operatives                         | COOP |
| 7     | Scottish Housing Register             | SHR  |
| 8     | Social Housing England                | SHPE |
| -     | Care Inspectorate Scotland            | CIS  |
| -     | Care Quality Commission               | CQC  |

Table 5: Precedence order of sources for matched organisations

## 2.2 Match types visualised

The plots in Figures 1, 2 and 3 show the number of matches between sources in the public spine. Figure 1 is an UpSetPlot, which is representation of intersection between all registers (like a venn diagram), shows how many matches are made between the different registers. Figure 2 is the same plot, without organisations which did not match with any other organisation, allowing for greater visualisation of the size of the matches on each axis. The bar chart in Figure 3 shows the number of matches by match type, showing the distribution of the types of linkages.

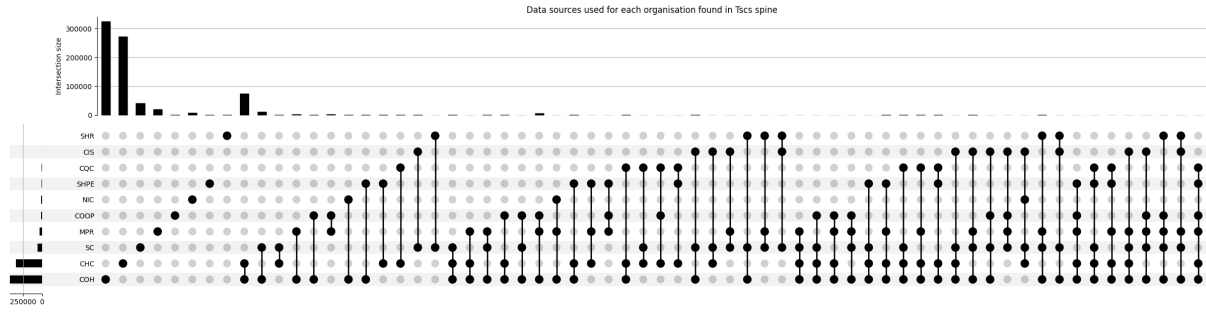


Figure 1: Sources each organisation is registered with

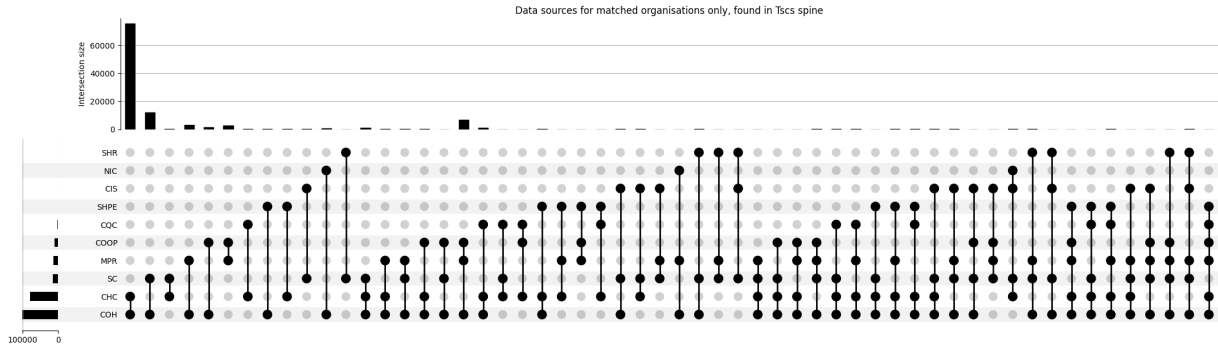


Figure 2: Sources each organisation is registered with, for all organisations in at least 2 registers

## 2.3 Determining primary organisations

The above techniques are used to match organisations between sources. Where a match occurs from within the same source regulator, the primary organisation is determined by the following rules:

- If an organisation from the Charity Commission for England and Wales matches an organisation from the same commission, the primary organisation uses the Find That Charity lookup to identify which of the two is the 'transferee' in a merger. The transferor is then linked to the transferee in the matches table, with the transferee being the primary organisation.
- In other cases where there are two organisations from the same regulator which match, the organisation considered primary is the one without a removal date (and is therefore still active), or the one with the most recent removal date (and was therefore active most recently).

If neither of these conditions lead to a decision, in particular where neither of the matched organisation have a removal date, the organisation with the earliest registration date is considered primary.

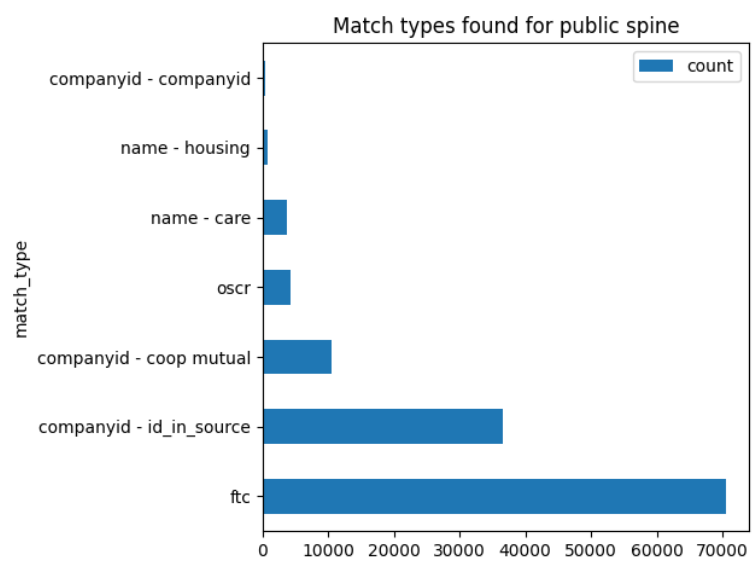


Figure 3: Distribution of match types used to deduplicate the spine

### 3 Ingesting data from each source

Each of the ten sources use different conventions for their databases. These needed to be pre-processed individually to accommodate different fieldnames, encodings, systems of marking alternative names, and so on. The pre-process step identified primary names and addresses for each organisation, choosing the most recent where multiple iterations exist, and storing alternatives for completeness.

More information about the processes for each source are found in the appendix, as well as the project source code<sup>4</sup>.

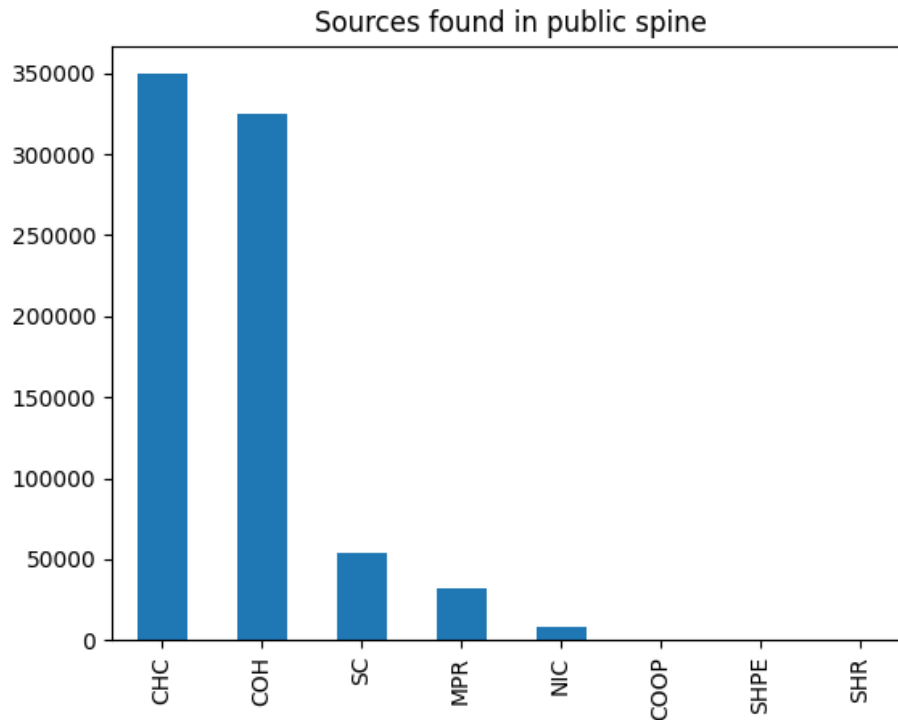


Figure 4: Sources found in public spine

| Source | Count of orgs in spine | Count of orgs matched to spine | Total count per source |
|--------|------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------|
| CHC    | 349572                 | 6432                           | 356004                 |
| SC     | 53339                  | 1424                           | 54763                  |
| NIC    | 8243                   | 0                              | 8243                   |
| COH    | 325166                 | 100631                         | 425797                 |
| COOP   | 651                    | 10451                          | 11102                  |
| MPR    | 32139                  | 0                              | 32139                  |
| SHR    | 112                    | 47                             | 159                    |
| SHPE   | 628                    | 715                            | 1343                   |
| CIS    | 0                      | 2183                           | 2183                   |
| CQC    | 0                      | 986                            | 986                    |

Table 6: Counts of organisations in the spine, and matched to the spine, from each source register

<sup>4</sup><https://github.com/uk-third-sector-database/tso-database-builder>

## Appendix: Data Sources

All data in the spine comes from publicly available sources. The number of organisations in the database (whether in the list of core organisation or via matching) are shown in Table 6.

Details for each source are given in the sections below.

### .1 Charity Commission for England and Wales (CCEW)

<https://www.gov.uk/government/organisations/charity-commission>

<https://register-of-charities.charitycommission.gov.uk/en/register/full-register-download>

#### .1.1 Recent CCEW downloads

'Public extract' data downloads are available at the CCEW website (above). We collected regular data downloads during 2024 and 2025, and in pre-processing we extract fields for name, address, registration date and removal date, along with charity number and linked charity number. We retain the date of the download, and where there are multiple options for any details we choose the most recent for the spine, and retain other information to be provided as supplementary data. All data is normalised, deduplicated and divided between primary and supplementary per charity number.

Typically the most recent data per charity number is allocated to the spine, and other data to the supplementary file. The exception to this is where the charity contains an entity with a 'linked charity number' of zero. CCEW uses this to indicate an overarching identity for a charity, with subsidiary entities being assigned non-zero integer values for linked charity number. The spine reflects this by using the data for the overarching charity, with subsidiaries added to supplementary data.

#### .1.2 Historical CCEW data

This section outlines the use of CCEW regulatory data in the construction of the third sector organisational spine<sup>5</sup>.

The initial processing of CCEW data for this project comprised 27 individual data files that were obtained between 2001 and 2023, along with updates lat. These files were used to compile a list of unique charities, and to extract as many unique names, addresses, registration dates, and removal dates for each organisation. These files are detailed below:

- CC\_appended\_March23.dta [English and Welsh Charity Register - March 2023]
- CC\_charity\_other\_names.dta [File containing additional names for English and Welsh charities - March 2023]
- ccr2001\_repaired.dta [Historical file from 2001, used to extract charity names, addresses, company numbers, dates of registration and removal]
- 24 historical snapshots from June 2011, March 2012 to 2019, April 2020 to 21, and March 2022 [Used to extract charity names, addresses, dates of registration and removal]

In order to compile all available information from these files, we created separate lists of unique names, addresses, registration dates, and removal dates. These lists were grouped using the identification number assigned to each charity by the CCEW (e.g., Stroud Earth Community in Gloucestershire operates under the charity number 1199586). These lists were then normalised in order to de-duplicate the information. For charity names,

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<sup>5</sup>For further detail on how this data was used, please see the Stata file `ccew_publicspine_prep.do` in the project GitHub repository.

this process entailed removing leading spaces, removing trailing spaces, collapsing consecutive internal spaces, and converting all characters to lower case. In the case of addresses, the same process was followed using a concatenated string comprising the first address line and the postcode. For registration and removal dates, we converted all dates to the same format (dd/mm/yyyy).

Once this normalisation was complete, we de-duplicated each list to keep only unique pieces of information. This de-duplication process keeps the first appearance of each piece of information and we provide variables in the dataset to show from which data iteration each value originates. These separate list of unique names, addresses, and dates are then compiled into a single dataset which is later merged with data from all other data sources. Using the historical file from 2001, we also extract 4,700 Companies House identification numbers that are absent from the later files we use (i.e., 2011–2023). Later in the process, we use Companies House IDs to link together the various data sources that produce the third sector organisational spine. The codebook of variables is found in Table 7.

### **.1.3 Limitations**

Despite the extensive temporal coverage of these data files (2001–2023), there are 13,243 unique charity numbers in the data for which we do not have address information. A large majority of these organisations were removed from the CCEW register before 1997. Similarly, three of these charity numbers do not have an organisation name in any of the data iterations used.

### **.1.4 Notes**

For a subset of charity numbers, the 2001-2023 data contain multiple dates of registration and/or removal. The data contains 341,990 unique charity numbers with 12,148 (3.55%) having more than one registration date. Of the 177,706 charity numbers that have a removal date, 4,074 (2.29%) have more than one. Below are some possible explanations for a charity having more than one date of registration or removal, though these are not exhaustive.

1. Data entry errors that are corrected in later data iterations.
2. The CCEW removes organisations that they believe have ceased operating. In some cases, the organisations are still active and the CCEW adds them back to the register once they have confirmed their continued activity. This creates multiple distinct dates for the same charity number.
3. These multiple values show the registration/removal dates for distinct organisations that have since merged into a single organisation with a single charity number. In this case, the component parts of the merger retain their distinct dates in historical data files and these are kept in the final organisational spine dataset. Related to point 3 above, there are charity numbers and organisations in the organisational spine that have since been merged into single entities. For more detail on this, please see data on merged charities held by the CCEW (<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/register-of-merged-charities>).

| Fieldname        | Notes                                                     |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| uid              | Unique ID assigned to each organisation in compiled data  |
| charitynumber    | ID assigned to each organisation by CCEW                  |
| organisationname | Name of organisation                                      |
| normalisedname   |                                                           |
| companyid        | ID assigned to organisation by Companies House            |
| houzenumber      |                                                           |
| addressline1     | First line of address                                     |
| addressline2     | Second line of address                                    |
| addressline3     | Third line of address                                     |
| addressline4     | Fourth line of address                                    |
| addressline5     | Fifth line of address                                     |
| city             | City                                                      |
| localauthority   | Local Authority area                                      |
| postcode         | Postcode                                                  |
| registerdate     | Date of registration                                      |
| removeddate      | Date of removal                                           |
| name_origin      | Iteration from which the organisation name originates     |
| address_origin   | Iteration from which the organisation address originates  |
| regdate_origin   | Iteration from which the registration date originates     |
| remdate_origin   | Iteration from which the removal date originates          |
| iteration        | Iteration from which all data in a given row originates   |
| source           | Variable to indicate the data source (in this case, CCEW) |

Table 7: Fields in pre-processing of CCEW data

## .2 Scottish Charity Regulator (OSCR)

<https://www.oscr.org.uk/>

This section outlines the use of OSCR regulatory data in the construction of the third sector organisational spine<sup>6</sup>.

The OSCR data used in this project comprised data files that were obtained between 2012 and 2025. These files were used to compile a list of unique charities, and to extract as many unique names, addresses, registration dates, and removal dates for each organisation. These files are detailed below:

- CharityExport-Removed-05-Dec-2025.csv : List of removed charities, December 2025
- CharityExport-03-Nov-2025.csv: Scottish Charity Register November 2025
- CharityExport-28-Jul-2025.csv: Scottish Charity Register July 2025
- CharityExport-05-Feb-2025.csv : Scottish Charity Register, February 2025
- CharityExport-Removed-05-Feb-2025.csv : List of removed charities, February 2025
- CharityExport-12-Apr-2023.csv : Scottish Charity Register, April 2023
- CharityExport-Removed-12-Apr-2023.csv : List of removed charities, April 2023
- oscr\_20210909.xlsx : Scottish Charity Register and Annual Returns, September 2021
- oscr\_20210203.xlsx : Scottish Charity Register and Annual Returns, February 2021
- oscr\_scr-and-ar\_20190109.xlsx : Scottish Charity Register and Annual Returns, January 2019
- sc\_chars2012.xlsx [Historical file from 2012]

In order to compile all available information from these files, we created separate lists of unique names, addresses, registration dates, and removal dates. These lists were grouped using the identification number assigned to each charity by OSCR (e.g., Inverness Civic Trust operates under the charity number SC021748). These lists were then normalised in order to de-duplicate the information. For charity names, this process entailed removing leading spaces, removing trailing spaces, collapsing consecutive internal spaces, and converting all characters to lower case. In the case of addresses, the same process was followed using a concatenated string comprising the first address line and the postcode. For registration and removal dates, we converted all dates to the same format (dd/mm/yyyy).

Once this normalisation was complete, we de-duplicated each list to keep only unique pieces of information. This de-duplication process keeps the first appearance of each piece of information and we provide variables in the dataset to show from which data iteration each value originates. These separate list of unique names, addresses, and dates are then compiled into a single dataset which is later merged with data from all other data sources. Finally, the 2012 historical data file includes additional charity regulator and companies house ID numbers. These additional IDs were gathered at the time the data file was created and we include them in the final dataset in case they prove useful for future research.

The codebook of variables is found in Table 8.

### .2.1 Limitations

There are 1,776 unique charity numbers in this data that don't have organisation names or any address information. Similarly, there is no useful data on registration or removal dates for these organisations. OSCR uses default values for registration (01/01/1992) and removal (02/06/2012) dates for many organisations in their data. For these 1,776 charities, all have the default removal date and all but two have the default registration

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<sup>6</sup>For further detail on how this data was used, please see the accompanying oscr\_publicspine\_prep.do file.

| Fieldname          | Notes                                                                                          |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| uid                | Unique ID assigned to each organisation in compiled data                                       |
| charitynumber      | ID assigned to each organisation by OSCR                                                       |
| organisationname   | Name of organisation                                                                           |
| normalisedname     |                                                                                                |
| companyid          | ID assigned to organisation by Companies House                                                 |
| address            | Full street address                                                                            |
| houenumber         |                                                                                                |
| addressline1       | First line of address                                                                          |
| addressline2       | Second line of address                                                                         |
| addressline3       | Third line of address                                                                          |
| addressline4       | Fourth line of address                                                                         |
| addressline5       | Fifth line of address                                                                          |
| addressline6       | Sixth line of address                                                                          |
| addressline7       | Seventh line of address                                                                        |
| addressline8       | Eighth line of address                                                                         |
| city               | City                                                                                           |
| localauthority     | Local Authority area                                                                           |
| postcode           | Postcode                                                                                       |
| registerdate       | Date of registration                                                                           |
| removeddate        | Date of removal                                                                                |
| name_origin        | Iteration from which the organisation name originates                                          |
| iteration          | Iteration from which all data in a given row originates                                        |
| charitynumber_2012 | Alternative OSCR ID (originates in 2012 data)                                                  |
| companyid1_2012    | Alternative Companies House ID (originates in 2012 data)                                       |
| companyid2_2012    | Alternative Companies House ID (originates in 2012 data)                                       |
| companyid3_2012    | Alternative Companies House ID (originates in 2012 data)                                       |
| source             | Variable to indicate the data source (in this case, OSCR)                                      |
| crossborder        | Boolean variable, reflecting whether 'Regulatory Type' is 'Cross Border' for this organisation |

Table 8: Fields in pre-processing of OSCR data

date. Due to the lack of organisation names, addresses, and dates for these organisations, we exclude them from the final dataset.

In addition to the 1,776 charities outlined above, there are 7,591 charities for which we don't have any address data. Of these 7,591 charities, 7,572 were removed from the register on the default date of 02/06/2012. Despite these limitations, these charities are retained in the final data because we do have info on charity name, registration date, and removal date. Finally, there are 194 charities for which we have street address information, but the data files do not contain the accompanying postcode. Of these 194 charities, 189 were removed from the charity register on the default date of 02/06/2012. These charities are also retained in the final data because we do have info on charity name, registration date, removal date, and partial address data.

## .2.2 Notes

The 2012 historical data file does not include any information on addresses, registration dates, or removal dates. As such, many of the names in our data file are first observed in 2012 while the earliest point of observation for the other key pieces of information is 2019.

### .3 Charity Commission for Northern Ireland (CCNI)

<https://www.charitycommissionni.org.uk/>

This section outlines the use of CCNI regulatory data in the construction of the third sector organisational spine<sup>7</sup>.

The CCNI data used in this project comprised of open data files obtained in

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- November 2025 (ccni-charitydetails\_2025\_11\_03.csv [data download])
- November 2025 (ni-removals-2025-11-03.csv [removals from the register, compiled via web scrape])
- May 2025 (charitydetails\_2025\_05\_19.csv [data download])
- May 2025 (ni-removals-2025-05-16.csv [removals from the register, compiled via web scrape])
- January 2025 (ccni-charitydetails\_2025\_01\_29\_14\_23\_47.csv [CCNI charity details - 29 January 2025])
- July 2024 (ni-removals-2024-07-18.csv [removals from the register, compiled via web scrape])
- April 2023 (ccni-charity-register-2023-04-19.csv [CCNI charity register - 19 April 2023])

These files were used to compile a list of unique charities with accompanying names, addresses, and registration dates for each organisation.

Unlike the preceding sections on CCEW and OSCR data, the research team did not have historical files to supplement the open data provided by the CCNI. Additionally, the CCNI data provide only one organisation name, address, and registration date per CCNI charity number (e.g., Sólás in Belfast operates under the charity number 100114). For organisations whose details differed between the two files, the most recent data was prioritised for the spine, and older data retained in the 'supplementary' table. This dataset is later merged with data from all other data sources.

The codebook of variables is found in Table 9.

#### .3.1 Limitations

Unlike the other charity regulator data sources, our data for CCNI does not alternative or historic unique names, addresses, or registration dates. At this point in time, the CCNI data is less comprehensive than its counterparts in England, Wales, and Scotland. Additionally, the CCNI does not provide information on the date that a charity is removed from the charity register. This further limits the CCNI data at this time.

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<sup>7</sup>For further detail on how this data was used, please see the accompanying ccni-publicspine\_prep.do file.

| Fieldname        | Notes                                                      |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| uid              | Unique ID assigned to each organisation in compiled data   |
| charitynumber    | ID assigned to each organisation by CCNI                   |
| organisationname | Name of organisation                                       |
| normalisedname   |                                                            |
| companyid        | ID assigned to organisation by Companies House             |
| hounumber        |                                                            |
| address          | Full street address and postcode                           |
| city             | City                                                       |
| localauthority   | Local Authority area                                       |
| postcode         | Postcode                                                   |
| registerdate     | Date of registration                                       |
| source           | Variable to indicate the data source (in this case - CCNI) |

Table 9: Fields in pre-processing of CCNI data

## .4 Mutuals Public Register

<https://mutuals.fca.org.uk/>

The Mutuals Public Register is a public record of mutual societies registered by the Financial Conduct Authority. Openly available register data has information for societies currently registered, and those no longer registered. For this project, downloads from June 2023, April 2024, and January, July and October 2025 are used. The field mapping is shown in Table 10.

| Fieldname        | Notes                                                                                                                        |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| uid              | Unique ID assigned to each organisation using 'GB-MPR-' + <b>Full Registration Number</b>                                    |
| organisationname | <b>Society Name</b>                                                                                                          |
| normalisedname   | Normalised version of organisationname                                                                                       |
| companyid        |                                                                                                                              |
| fulladdress      | <b>Society Address</b>                                                                                                       |
| city             |                                                                                                                              |
| postcode         | Postcode taken from <b>Society Address</b> :<br>= last two 'words' of address if their lengths are at most 4 characters each |
| registerdate     | <b>Registration Date</b> mapped from yyyy-mm-dd format to dd/mm/yyyy                                                         |
| removeddate      | <b>Deregistration Date</b> mapped from yyyy-mm-dd format to dd/mm/yyyy                                                       |
| source           | Variable to indicate the data source (in this case - MPR)                                                                    |

Table 10: Fields in pre-processing of Mutuals data (bold text indicates fieldname in Mutuals Public Register data)

Where an organisation has multiple options for name and address, the most recent is used in the primary data, and alternatives are stored in supplementary data.

## .5 Companies House

<https://www.gov.uk/government/organisations/companies-house>

Companies House release a bulk download every quarter of all currently live companies<sup>8</sup>. The Alpha public spine incorporates these downloads for April, June and October 2023, March, May and September 2024, and January, July and November 2025.

Using bulk downloads alone would mean organisations that were dissolved earlier than 2023 would not be present in the database. Using the Companies House API we found all companies registered and dissolved which fit our inclusion criteria (see Table 11 for included company types). The code used to search the API is found in our github repository [https://github.com/uk-third-sector-database/ch\\_adv\\_scraper](https://github.com/uk-third-sector-database/ch_adv_scraper). Additionally, since the bulk download does not contain any removed organisations, it contains no removal dates. The API scraped data is used to fill in this field for all removed organisations.

### .5.1 Company types

Companies house data includes a 'company category' for each organisation. Table 11 shows the full list of these, indicating which have been included in the public spine data.

| Company category                                                                          | Included / Excluded |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Charitable Incorporated Organisation                                                      | Included            |
| Community Interest Company                                                                | Included            |
| Industrial and Provident Society                                                          | Included            |
| PRI/LBG/NSC (Private, Limited by guarantee, no share capital, use of 'Limited' exemption) | Included            |
| PRI/LTD BY GUAR/NSC (Private, limited by guarantee, no share capital)                     | Included            |
| Registered Society                                                                        | Included            |
| Scottish Charitable Incorporated Organisation                                             | Included            |
| Converted/Closed                                                                          | Included            |
| Private Limited Company                                                                   | Excluded            |
| Limited Partnership                                                                       | Excluded            |
| Limited Liability Partnership                                                             | Excluded            |
| Public Limited Company                                                                    | Excluded            |
| Private Unlimited Company                                                                 | Excluded            |
| Scottish Partnership                                                                      | Excluded            |
| Private Unlimited                                                                         | Excluded            |
| Investment Company with Variable Capital(Umbrella)                                        | Excluded            |
| PRIV LTD SECT. 30 (Private limited company, section 30 of the Companies Act)              | Excluded            |
| Investment Company with Variable Capital (Securities)                                     | Excluded            |
| Investment Company with Variable Capital                                                  | Excluded            |
| Overseas Entity                                                                           | Excluded            |
| United Kingdom Economic Interest Grouping                                                 | Excluded            |
| Old Public Company                                                                        | Excluded            |
| United Kingdom Societas                                                                   | Excluded            |
| Other Company Type                                                                        | Excluded            |
| Protected Cell Company                                                                    | Excluded            |
| Royal Charter Company                                                                     | Excluded            |
| Further Education and Sixth Form College Corps                                            | Excluded            |
| Other company type                                                                        | Excluded            |

Table 11: Companies house 'company category' field

Each of the companies house data sources were pre-processed to identify primary name and address for each included organisation, with any alternative names and addresses also stored. The sources were then also

<sup>8</sup>[https://download.companieshouse.gov.uk/en\\_output.html](https://download.companieshouse.gov.uk/en_output.html)

combined, since there is significant overlap between them, and the most recent name and address per organisation was included in the companies house spine data, to be used for matching with other registries to form the public spine.

Compressing the company type categories such that all Community Interest Companies are grouped, and all remaining companies which are limited by guarantee (with or without 'limited exemption', with or without 'private'), gives the counts shown in Table 12, and in Figure 5.

| Company type                                  | Count  |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------|
| Company Limited by Guarantee                  | 478977 |
| Community Interest Company                    | 123588 |
| Charitable Incorporated Organisation          | 41410  |
| Registered Society                            | 11200  |
| Scottish Charitable Incorporated Organisation | 7548   |
| Industrial and Provident Society              | 162    |

Table 12: Distribution of company types in dataset (compressed company types).

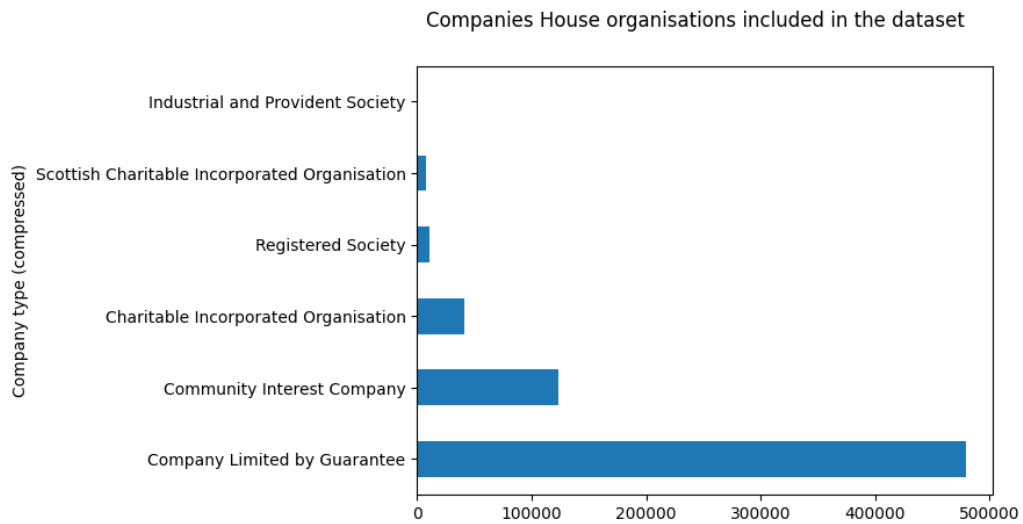


Figure 5: Companies house organisations by company type (compressed).

## .6 Co-operatives

<https://www.uk.coop/resources/open-data>

The Co-operatives UK organisations used in this project were from open data downloads in April 2022, April 2024 and January, July and October 2025. Open data from the Co-operatives UK organisation was mapped to the format required by the public spine according to the rules shown in Table 13 below.

| Fieldname                                   | Notes                                                                                 |
|---------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| uid                                         | Unique ID assigned to each organisation using 'GB-COOP-' + <b>CUK Organisation ID</b> |
| organisationname                            | <b>Registered Name</b>                                                                |
| normalisedname                              | Normalised version of organisationname                                                |
| companyid                                   | <b>Registered Number</b><br>(COOPs data links to Mutuals data using this field)       |
| fulladdress                                 | <b>Registered Street</b>                                                              |
| city                                        | <b>Registered City</b>                                                                |
| postcode                                    | <b>Registered Postcode</b>                                                            |
| registerdate                                | <b>Incorporation Date</b>                                                             |
| removeddate                                 | <b>Dissolved Date</b>                                                                 |
| source                                      | Variable to indicate the data source (in this case - COOP)                            |
| organisationname<br>(in supplementary data) | <b>Trading Name</b>                                                                   |

Table 13: Fields in pre-processing of COOP data (bold text indicates fieldname in co-op open data)

Where an organisation has multiple options for name and address, the most recent is used in the primary data, and alternatives are stored in supplementary data.

## .7 Scottish Housing Register

<https://www.housingregulator.gov.scot/landlord-performance/statistical-information/>

The Scottish Housing Regulator for social landlords publishes organisational data which has been included in the spine. Datasets used in this project were annual downloads collected in 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2024, 2025. Table 14 shows the how the spine fields relate to the provided data.

| Fieldname        | Notes                                                                   |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| uid              | Unique ID assigned to each organisation using 'GB-SHR-' + <b>Reg No</b> |
| organisationname | <b>Social Landlord</b>                                                  |
| normalisedname   | Normalised version of organisationname                                  |
| companyid        |                                                                         |
| fulladdress      |                                                                         |
| city             |                                                                         |
| postcode         |                                                                         |
| registerdate     |                                                                         |
| removeddate      |                                                                         |
| source           | Variable to indicate the data source (in this case - SHR)               |

Table 14: Fields in pre-processing of Scottish Housing Regulator data (bold text indicates fieldname in register)

Where an organisation has multiple options for name and address, the most recent is used in the primary data, and alternatives are stored in supplementary data.

## .8 Social Housing England

<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/registered-providers-of-social-housing>

The government publishes a download monthly of registered social housing providers in England. The data in the spine is compiled from downloads accessed January 2023, January, July and October 2025. The mapping to the fields seen in the spine is shown in Table 15.

| Fieldname        | Notes                                                                                 |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| uid              | Unique ID assigned to each organisation using 'GB-SHPE-' + <b>Registration number</b> |
| organisationname | <b>Organisation name</b>                                                              |
| normalisedname   | Normalised version of organisationname                                                |
| companyid        |                                                                                       |
| fulladdress      |                                                                                       |
| city             |                                                                                       |
| postcode         |                                                                                       |
| registerdate     | <b>Registration date</b>                                                              |
| removeddate      |                                                                                       |
| source           | Variable to indicate the data source (in this case - SHPE)                            |

Table 15: Fields in pre-processing of Social Housing Providers England data (bold text indicates fieldname in register)

Where an organisation has multiple options for name and address, the most recent is used in the primary data, and alternatives are stored in supplementary data.

## .9 Care Inspectorate Scotland

<https://www.careinspectorate.com/index.php/statistics-and-analysis/data-and-analysis>

Care Inspectorate Scotland release data at their financial year end (March 31st). This dataset uses data published in the years 2015 to 2025 inclusive. Organisations are included where field "Service Type" = 'Voluntary or Not for Profit'. Organisations have both a 'Provider Name' and a 'Service Name' in the Care Inspectorate data. We have retained Service Names, however the primary name for matching is the Provider Name. Table 16 shows the fields used to develop the spine.

| Fieldname                                   | Notes                                                                                                              |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| uid                                         | Unique ID assigned to each organisation using 'GB-CIS-' + <b>CSNumber</b> or <b>CaseNumber</b>                     |
| organisationname                            | <b>ServiceProvider</b>                                                                                             |
| normalisedname                              | Normalised version of organisationname                                                                             |
| companyid                                   |                                                                                                                    |
| fulladdress                                 | Concatenation of <b>Address_line_1</b> , <b>Address_line_2</b> , <b>Address_line_3</b> , and <b>Address_line_4</b> |
| city                                        | <b>Service_town</b>                                                                                                |
| postcode                                    | <b>Service_Postcode</b>                                                                                            |
| registerdate                                | <b>DateReg</b>                                                                                                     |
| removeddate                                 |                                                                                                                    |
| source                                      | Variable to indicate the data source (in this case - CIS)                                                          |
| organisationname<br>(in supplementary data) | <b>ServiceName</b>                                                                                                 |

Table 16: Fields in pre-processing of Care Inspectorate Scotland data (bold text indicates fieldname in register)

## .10 Care Quality Commission

<https://www.cqc.org.uk/about-us/transparency/using-cqc-data>

Data from the Care Quality Commission is available as a Directory Download from their website. Monthly snapshots are retrievable from their linked drive space. For this product we have used downloads from January 2023, April 2024, and January, July and October 2025. Table 17 shows the mapping between CQC data fields and spine fields.

| Fieldname                                   | Notes                                                                                                  |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| uid                                         | Unique ID assigned to each organisation using 'GB-CQC-' + <b>CQC Provider ID (for office use only)</b> |
| organisationname                            | <b>Provider name</b>                                                                                   |
| normalisedname                              | Normalised version of organisationname                                                                 |
| companyid                                   |                                                                                                        |
| fulladdress                                 | <b>Address</b>                                                                                         |
| city                                        |                                                                                                        |
| postcode                                    | <b>Postcode</b>                                                                                        |
| registerdate                                |                                                                                                        |
| removeddate                                 |                                                                                                        |
| source                                      | Variable to indicate the data source (in this case - CQC)                                              |
| organisationname<br>(in supplementary data) | <b>Name</b>                                                                                            |
| organisationname<br>(in supplementary data) | <b>Also known as</b>                                                                                   |

Table 17: Fields in pre-processing of Care Inspectorate Scotland data (bold text indicates fieldname in register)